

Bylaws of the Lambda Nu Chapter of ZETA TAU ALPHA

Article I - Name Of This association shall be known as Lambda Nu Chapter of Zeta Tau Alpha Fraternity.

Article II – Object

- A. The object of this organization shall be to promote the purpose and program of the Fraternity; to function as a constructive, vital force in the lives of its members; to cooperate with the local alumnae and to serve as a cooperative, active part of the university program.

Article III – Membership

- A. New Member – any regularly enrolled female student at Furman University, regardless of race, color, national origin, religion, political affiliation, handicap or age, who has met the eligibility requirements set forth in the National Constitution and Bylaws, the national policies (as set forth in the General Manual), the Lambda Nu Chapter Bylaws and Furman University is eligible for membership in the Lambda Nu chapter.
- B. Re-pledge – a woman may not be re-pledged for the third semester without the written permission of the Vice President Collegiate.
- C. Members – membership in Lambda Nu Chapter may be extended to regularly enrolled collegiate women who meet the standards of the Fraternity and the requirements set forth in the National Constitution and Bylaws, who have completed a full-time semester (12 credit hours) at a college or university, and who have a minimum 2.5 grade point average.
- D. Transfers – a transferring member of Zeta Tau Alpha may affiliate with the chapter according to the policies and procedures outlined in the General Manual.
- E. GreekLifeEdu: Completing GreekLifeEdu is a requirement for all initiated members. New members will be given a first deadline by which they must complete the first portion of GreekLifeEdu. If any Initiated Member or New Member misses the first deadline, social privileges will be revoked until they complete it. New Members must complete GreekLifeEdu by the determined timeline in order to be initiated.
- F. All members and new members must review and sign the Membership Expectations and Obligations Contract. Each fall, all returning members are expected to review this policy and initial the contract, prior to any event with alcohol. All members are expected to abide by the contract. Failure to do so may result in Judicial action.

Article IV – Meetings

Section I – Chapter Meetings

- A. There will be a regular meeting (business, ritual or standard) each week during the college year except during examination, and vacation periods.
- B. A simple majority of the eligible voting membership shall compose a quorum at any regular meeting.
- C. The right to vote shall be accorded every member and new member who is: present, in good financial standing, in good scholastic standing and has completed the Post Initiate Education (PIE).

- D. Good standing shall be defined as having earned a cumulative GPA of 2.5 and being up to date on the payment plan for dues. Being in good standing gives members the privilege to attend all social events, as well as vote.
- E. To remain in good standing, members may not miss more than 2 meetings a semester (unexcused). Excused absences will be reviewed on a case by case basis and must be submitted to the Recording Secretary 24 hours before the meeting.
- F. Proper ritual attire will be required for all rituals and if not approved by the Ritual chair, then the member will be asked to leave and will receive a fine and loss of points.

Section II – Executive Committee Meetings

- A. Executive Committee meetings shall be held once a week at a regularly scheduled time and place.
- B. All chapter business must be brought before the Executive Committee before being discussed in chapter meetings.
- C. All executive council members must be present for 80% of the executive council meetings. (can't miss more than 20%)

Section III – Special Meetings

- A. Special meetings may be held only when the General Advisor and every member and new member of the chapter has been notified.
- B. 51% of the eligible voting membership shall compose a quorum at any special meeting.

Section IV – New Member Meetings

- A. New members shall hold a regular weekly meeting under the supervision of the 2nd Vice President-New Member Coordinator and New Member Advisor until their initiation.

Section V – Program Council Meetings

- A. Program Council meetings shall be held weekly at a regularly scheduled time and place with the VPI-Coordinator of Committees presiding.
- B. Program Council members are required to attend all Program Council Meetings unless a valid excuse is provided at least 24 hours prior to the meeting.
- C. Failure to attend meetings without a valid excuse or failure to fulfill the obligations of your position will have a meeting with the President and VPI who will determine the proper course of action.
- D. Special Committees – the chair and/or members of special committees shall attend Program Council meetings to discuss their events/programs, as they are being developed and planned so that the event/program can be approved using the EC/PC Process.

Article V – Power and Duties

- A. The organization shall exercise all powers usually vested in such a body, provided these do not conflict within the provisions set forth in the National Constitution and Bylaws, the manuals of the Fraternity, the national policies and directives of the Fraternity. The disciplinary powers of the Lambda Nu chapter shall be vested

in the chapter Judicial Committee.

Article VI – Officers

A. Section I –Officers

- B. Officers shall be those specified in the National Constitution and Bylaws and in The Guide to Collegiate Chapters.
- C. Elected officers are the Executive Council and include the following officers: President, First Vice President (Coordinator of Committees), Second Vice President (New Member Coordinator), Third Vice President (Membership Chairman), Fourth Vice President (Philanthropy Chairman), Recording Secretary, Treasurer, Historian-Reporter, Ritual Chairman, Panhellenic Delegate, Risk Management Chairman and Academic Achievement Chairman.

Section II – Elections

- A. Elections shall follow the guidelines as stated in The Guide for Chapter Officers.
- B. The Nominating Committee shall be elected with one representative from each pledge class. The General Advisor and outgoing President shall serve as an ex-officio member of the committee. If the outgoing President is running for another Executive position, she will not serve on the committee.
- C. Those interested in running for any Executive Committee position must turn in an application and interview with the Nominating Committee. Only those who have turned in an application and interviewed with the Nominating Committee may be nominated from the floor during elections.
- D. Those planning to study away should not plan to apply for executive council. If approved by the president, the application must have a statement of intent on studying away in a specific semester.
- E. The slate of officers shall be submitted by the Nominating Committee to the chapter one week before elections.
- F. The Nominating Committee shall make a motion to accept the slate of nominated candidates for office. If the slate does not pass by a simple majority vote of the quorum present, nominations will be taken from the floor. Nominees from the floor must have turned in an application and interviewed with the Nominating Committee. Elections will proceed as outlined in The Guide for Chapter Officers.
- F. If the slate does not pass, Executive Committee positions will be voted on by an individual basis, beginning with President. Nominations may be taken from the floor for each office at this time.
- G. The chapter shall sit in alphabetical order and ballots will be used. Ballots will be counted by an advisor or another alumna present.
- H. If a vacancy in the office of President occurs, the First Vice President assumes the office. If there is no First Vice President, the Executive Council, with the approval of the Advisory Board and the Province President/Director of New Chapters, appoints a new President.
- I. If a vacancy in any other officer or chairmanship occurs, the President, with the approval of the Executive Council, the General Advisor and the Province President/Director of New Chapters, appoints a replacement.
- J. Elections shall take place in the fall semester.

Section III – Qualifications

- A. To be eligible, a member must meet the qualifications specified in the National Constitution and Bylaws, the General Manual and The Guide for Chapter Officers.
 - a. President: The President must be an initiated member for at least 2 semesters and previously served in an Executive Council office or held a leadership position within the chapter.
 - b. VP1: The VP1 must have successfully completed at least one term in a Program Council position.
 - c. VP3: The VP3 must have completed at least one formal recruitment season as an initiated member before assuming the position.
 - d. VP4: The VP4 must have successfully completed at least one term in a Philanthropy Committee position or at least one successful term on Program Council or Executive Council.
 - B. Executive Council members must have a 2.5 cumulative GPA to be elected and retain office.
 - C. Special consideration may be given to those below the minimum GPA requirement if approved in advance by the Director of New Chapters/Province President.
 - D. No officer may be elected or retain office while on disciplinary probation with the University and/or Zeta Tau Alpha.
 - E. If any of the above qualifications are not met, the nomination must be approved by the DNCH/Province President.
 - F. Newly elected Executive Committee officers must attend Lambda Nu Officer Training and any other national training required for their position. Newly appointed Program Council officers must attend Lambda Nu Officer Training.
- Section IV – Duties

- A. The duties of office shall be those usually assigned to such officers in Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised and such other duties as are specifically stated in The Guide to Chapter Officers.
- B. Failure to fulfill responsibilities of office will result in disciplinary action.

Section V – Term of Office

- A. Officers shall be installed after Officer Education and no later than one month after elections. Officers shall hold office for one year.

Section VI - Officer Education

- A. All old and new Executive Committee Officers and Program Council officers are required to attend an officer training retreat before the end of the fall semester and before they are officially installed as officers of the chapter, as outlined in The Guide for Officer Education and Leadership Development and The Guide for Chapter Officers. This is to be planned and conducted by the outgoing President with assistance from other outgoing officers, as needed.

Article VII – Standing Committees

Section I – Standing Committees

- A. Standing Committees are the appointed officers, which comprise the Program Council. These include the following directors and chairmen:
 - a. Director of Activities and Special Events .

- i. Apparel Chairman
 - ii. Signs/Banner Chairman
 - iii. Intramurals Chairman
- b. Director of Fraternity Education (FRED)
- c. Philanthropy - Director is VP4
 - i. Think Pink Chairman
 - ii. Service Chairman
- d. Director of Social Events and External Socials
- e. Director of Member Enrichment/Links
- f. Director of Sisterhood
- g. Alumnae Collegiate Relations and Parent Events Chairman, Music Chairman
- h. Corresponding Secretary

Section II – Special Committees

- A. Special Committees include but are not limited to: Philanthropy, Tailgate, and Homecoming.
- B. Additional Committees may be created by the chapter Executive Council and the Advisory Board as the need arises.

Section III – Qualifications for Office

- A. To be eligible for Program Council, a member must meet the qualifications specified in the National Constitution and Bylaws, the General Manual and The Guide for Chapter Officers.
- B. Program Council members must have a 2.5 cumulative GPA, to be elected and retain office.
- C. No officer may be appointed or retain office while on disciplinary probation with the University and/or Zeta Tau Alpha.
- D. If any of the above qualifications are not met, the appointment must be approved by the Director of New Chapters/Province President.

Section IV - Appointment

- A. Members interested in holding a Program Council position must file an application stating their preferences with the First Vice President.
- B. Program Council officers and their committees shall be appointed by the President and First Vice President.
- C. Committees should be appointed within three weeks of election of officers to allow for participation in Officer Education.

Section V – Duties

- A. Duties of the committees shall be those usually assigned to such committees in Robert's Rules of Order, Newly-Revised and such other duties as are specifically stated in The Guide for Chapter Officers and as determined by the chapter Executive Council with approval of the Advisory Board and Director of New Chapters.

Section VI – Term of Office

- A. Program Council Chairmen and their committees shall assume duties after

- appointment and shall hold office until next year's election.
- B. Failure to fulfill the responsibilities as dictated by the contract provided by VPI may result in termination of the position.

Section I – Advisory Board

Article VIII – Chapter Advisors

- A. The chapter advisory board shall consist of a minimum of four alumnae advisors: General, New Member, Membership and Financial. If available, the positions of Program Council, Judicial, Academic Achievement, Ritual and Social Advisors will be filled. Other advisor positions can be filled as deemed necessary.

Section II – Qualifications

- A. The nominating committee must secure the approval of the DNCH/Province President before an alumna may be considered for any chapter advisor position.

Section III – Election of Advisors

- A. The election of advisors shall take place from a list of available alumnae supplied by the Executive Council of the alumnae chapter at the same time as the election of chapter officers, as specified in The General Manual. Advisors must be approved by the DNCH/Province President prior to appointment.
- B. If an advisor becomes inactive or resigns, replacement is handled in the same manner.

Section IV – Duties

- A. The duties and responsibilities of advisors shall be those stated in the Guide for Advisors.

Section V – Term of Office

- A. Election of advisors shall coincide with the chapter election of officers and shall hold office for one year.

Section VI – Advisory Board Meetings

- A. Alumnae advisors will meet monthly as a board and also jointly with the Executive Council and Program Council when possible or necessary.

Article IX – Finances

Section I – Budgets

- A. The chapter shall operate within a budget approved by the National Secretary-Treasurer.

Section II – Income

- A. Dues, social fees, and other charges shall be as approved in the annual budget.
- B. Members must abide by the financial policies as outline in the General Manual

and the Guide to Chapter Finances.

- C. No member will be permitted to attend chapter social events if she is not in good financial standing as stated in the Guide to Chapter Finances.

Section III – Fines

- A. National fines shall be as imposed by National Officers. Local fines for unexcused absences shall be as follows:

- a. Event Fine

- b. Recruitment Event \$50

- i. (Fine will be per party during formal recruitment and is also at the discretion of VPIII which may include but is not limited to workshops, PhiredUp, pop-ins ...etc)

- c. Ritual (other than Initiation) \$25

- i. (Mandatory rituals will be made clear at least one month in advance. Rituals will include but are not limited to formal chapter, Big Sister ceremony, and formal pledging)

- d. Initiation \$75

- e. Philanthropy \$50

- i. (mandatory events, such as BMOC, Lip Sync, and Making Strides - specified by exec at least one month in advance)

- f. Chapter \$15

- i. (Members are allowed two unexcused absences. For every unexcused chapter meeting after this they will be fined \$15 per chapter)

- g. Zeta Day \$80

- i. (if you sign up to attend and do not go or if you fail to sign up without a submitting a valid excuse)

- B. Additional fineable events will be announced as soon as they are known. These events could include events such as workshops hosted by Panhellenic. The Executive Council will decide the appropriate amount to fine depending on the event.
- C. Missed events will be billed immediately following the event. National Fraternity policies will be followed with regard to collecting these fees. Any member who is more than 10 days delinquent in her payment will lose both social and voting privileges until she has met her financial obligations.
- D. Chapter meeting excuses must be submitted no later than 24 hours before the date of the meeting. All excuses for other mandatory events must be submitted one week in advance of the event. If an excuse is received after this time frame it will be considered an unexcused absence and the member will be subject to a fine. See Article X Section II for a list of acceptable excuses
- E. In the case of illness or emergency, please notify the Recording Secretary by phone. Members who do not notify the Recording Secretary prior to the activity will be fined.
- F. EC Reserves the right to modify fines as work day fines if the specific person comes to EC with a concern

Section IV – Reduced Fees

- A. All members who student teach, co-op, or intern a minimum of 60 miles off campus or approximately 1 hour away while participating in a college sponsored program are to be charged per capita, insurance, scholarship, and House Reserve Fund only, if so approved by the National Secretary-Treasurer. Permission must

be received in writing the semester before fees can be lowered.

Section I – Points System

Article X – Attendance and Participation

A points system shall be maintained to monitor and ensure active participation in chapter activities. The current points system is explained in Article XI and outlined in Appendix A.

Section II – Acceptable excuses for mandatory events

- A. Acceptable excuses for mandatory events include the following:
 - a. Sickness with doctor documentation
 - b. Death or funeral
 - c. Class or exam
 - d. Family emergency
 - e. Group project with proof from professor
 - f. Career fairs
 - g. Work or work interview
 - h. Scheduled vacation with proof of ticket purchase before the semester calendar was presented
 - i. Athletic team game, practice, or other required event (such as team dinner) specified as mandatory by the coach.
 - j. Religious activities, holidays, or events
 - k. Other required events for class or other required events for campus organizations in which you are an official representative of Furman
- B. Excuses must be sent to the Recording Secretary one week in advance of the scheduled activity, except in the case of illness or emergency. In the case of illness or emergency, please notify the Recording Secretary by phone. Members who do not notify the Recording Secretary prior to the activity will not receive points. Members should be ready to submit proof of their excuse to the Recording Secretary. Failure to submit proof of an excuse will result in the event being counted as unexcused and relevant fines will be applied.

Section III – Required Involvement

- A. Every member must be involved in an outside campus activity. In the event that a member is not involved, that member will have a meeting with the Director of Activities.
- B. All members must participate in a minimum of 3 service points each semester. At least one service point requirement must be held in chapter, approved and planned by the Service Chairman. At least one service point must be an outside event and will be approved by the Service Chairman and Recording Secretary when points are submitted. The last service point may be in chapter or may be an outside volunteer event.

ARTICLE XI - POINT POLICY

- A. Points will be updated on a weekly basis and can be found on the GIN System.
- B. Points will accumulate for a semester and will renew at the beginning of each semester.
- C. Should the University acquire housing, totals will be archived from the previous

fall semester and added to the current winter semester to create the ranking of members for live-in selections.

Section I: Purpose

- A. The purpose of the points system is to encourage attendance at all chapter activities and participation in other campus organizations by allowing the individual members to choose those meetings and functions that best fit into her schedule. Every member must complete a certain number of events per category, as indicated by a specific color out of a possible maximum number of events per color coordinated category to remain in good member standing. Failure to meet point requirements specified at the beginning of each semester by the indicated deadlines will result in the loss of social privileges. Failure to obtain all required points by the end of the semester will result in the member appearing before the Judicial Committee.
- B. This design is heavily reliant on executive council (especially the efforts of the President, Vice President I, Vice President IIII, and Recording Secretary) to produce a series of monthly calendars containing all semester events broken down by category by the beginning of each semester. The corresponding colors and categories are as follows:
 - a. Chapter meetings
 - b. Philanthropy events
 - c. Rituals
 - d. Sisterhood events
 - e. External events

Section III: Points System Process

- A. Every member will receive a calendar each semester, which lists all scheduled activities. In order to include an activity on the point's calendar, the chapter must be notified at least two weeks prior to the event.
- B. Extra points for non-required events may be given to encourage member participation.
- C. Points will be posted on GIN by the Recording Secretary

Article XII – Academic Achievement

Section I – Member Study Hours

- A. Any member making below a 2.5 for the previous semester will meet or contact with the Academic Achievement Chair at the beginning of the semester with a study plan for the upcoming semester.
- B. Study hours are to be completed by both Initiated Members and New Members and will be implemented by the Academic Achievement Chairman using the following guidelines based on each member's prior semester GPA:

3.0+ 0 hours

2.75-2.99 3 hours

2.5-2.74 4 hours

2.30-2.49 5 hours

2.29-below 6 hours

Section II – Study Hours Procedures

- A. Special permission to study away from the library for studio hours, editing lab hours, etc. may be approved by AACH only. This must be done prior to the event. Study hall hours are done every week and excess hours do not roll over. Incomplete study hall hours carry over until all hours have been completed. Lack of completing study hall hours will result in:
 - a. The member or new member will be placed on temporary Social Probation until the hours are completed and the member has consulted with the AACH.
 - b. Failure to attend monitored study hall for two consecutive weeks, or falling 10 hours behind, will result in AACH referral to the Judicial Committee.

Article XIII – Online Website Regulation

- A. Absolutely NO Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, Snapchat or any social media or photos, videos, or texts and captions may depict:
 - a. Alcohol consumption or possession with the exception of if the individual is in another country where alcohol consumption is legal or if the individual is over the age of 21. If this is the case, the post must clearly indicate where the photo was taken.
 - b. Illicit drug consumption or possession
 - c. Abusing, harassing, or bullying any other individuals
 - d. Use of ZTA letters or symbols in the presences of alcohol
 - e. Material that is obscene, pornographic, or otherwise offensive
 - B. Profiles of a Zeta are NOT to include:
 - a. Discussion of alcohol consumption or possession
 - b. Discussion of drug consumption or possession
 - c. Discussion with obscene, pornographic, or otherwise offensive content
- Strike System:
- a. Members must let all officers follow all of their social media accounts including but not limited to Facebook, Instagram, Snapchat, any “finstas” ... etc. Additionally, all members with Instagrams must allow the @furmanzta to follow their accounts.
 - b. If a member takes down a post within 24 hours (or 4 hours for Snapchat or Instagram story) of being asked to do so by a member of the Executive Council, that member will receive a “true warning.” A “true warning” may only be received once and every subsequent warning will be considered as a strike. However, if said member fails to take down the post, their action will result in a strike.
 - c. Members will be notified of the need to remove their social media post by strawberry emoji if the post needs to be removed or the “monocle man” emoji if the caption needs to be changed because it violates one or more of the requirements stated above. For Snapchat stories, the member will be notified directly by an officer if their story needs to be taken down.
 - d. After receiving two strikes, the member must meet with the President for a discussion of their actions.

- e. After the third strike and for each subsequent strike, the member will be sent to Judicial.
- f. At the beginning of each calendar year, strikes will be reset to 0 for all members.

Article XIV – Socials

- A. All members must conduct themselves in a manner consistent with all standards, regulations, and values of Zeta Tau Alpha. If any ZTA member is found not upholding these morals at any ZTA function/event, the following will result:
 - a. The first time a member is seen conducting herself in a manner not becoming of ZTA policies, a Sober Sister will verbally confront the sister and give her a warning
 - b. The second time, at the same social, a member is seen conducting herself in a manner not becoming of ZTA policies a Sober Sister will arrange for her to leave the social, and she will be subject to judicial charges.
 - c. Sober Sisters will record each warning on the Zeta attendance sheet. Before a Sober Sister confronts a sister they will consult the list to determine if it is her first or second offense of the night.
 - d. Any ZTA member that brings a guest to a social is fully responsible for that guest's actions and behaviors and may be subject to judicial proceedings.

Article XV – Procedures

- A. All matters of procedure not covered by these Bylaws shall be governed by Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised.

Article Amendments

- A. These Bylaws may be amended by a 2/3 vote of the membership provided the proposed amendments were presented at the previous meeting and previously approved by the Province President/Director of New Chapters. Bylaws should be revised every 2 years.

Appendix A: Points· Refer to attached Points document.

Stephanie Trame, Recording Secretary 2023

Marissa Schabes, President 2023

Coryn Owens Edgar, VI Beta Province President 2023